

Five minutes, one voice

Katerina presents the whole thing. Sebastian and Stefan are credited on the team slide and named out loud — nobody has to hand over, which removes the one thing that reliably breaks a group pitch.

WHEN	LENGTH	SPEAKING	HANDOFFS	HACKATHON
Thu 16:30	5 minutes	4:25	0	28–30 Sep

WHAT THIS ROUND DECIDES

The judges are picking a team to send, not grading a business plan

They are asking two things: **do I understand this in the first twenty seconds**, and **will this team deliver at the event**. Market size and financial detail are not being decided here.

So the pitch leads with the one advantage almost nobody else in the room has: **this is a deployed product, not an idea**. Then, because the room is Turing College and everyone in it knows what a state graph and a vector index are, it shows the architecture rather than hiding it.

The one fact that shapes this pitch. Battle of the Tech Schools runs 28–30 September, and **the challenge brief is not released until 10:00 on day one** — an AI build on real Berlin data, working prototype in 48 hours, five-member teams mixing data, engineering and web. So **Produce Your Brand is not the hackathon project**. It is the evidence that this team ships. Never promise what you will build there; you cannot know, and the judges know you cannot.

Presenting alone is an advantage here, not a compromise. One voice, one laptop, no seam where a three-person pitch stalls, and 35 seconds of real buffer at the end. Speaking solo also means you can absorb a slow demo by trimming later — the cut points are marked in the script.

TIMELINE

Nine beats, and the last 35 seconds are deliberately empty

0:00

1 The one sentence 20 s

Plus the pause. This is the only part to know cold.

0:20

2 The boundary 20 s

What we are not: ordinary print. Pre-empts half the questions.

0:40

3 Four unknowns 15 s

Delivered fast, as a list. Do not elaborate on any of them.

0:55

4 The interview quote 10 s

Doubles as the way into the demo, so there is no awkward transition.

1:05

5 Live demo 75 s · the centrepiece

Four beats on the real deployed product.

2:20

6 The architecture 45 s

Slide 07. Walk the rows, not the boxes. The technical audience is the reason this slide exists.

3:05

7 The line to land, then the team 30 s

Which row has no AI in it — then name Sebastian and Stefan and the skills each brings.

3:35

8 Why us for an unseen brief 35 s

The brief is secret until day one, so this is about track record, not roadmap. The strongest thing you say in a round about execution.

4:10

9 The close 15 s

The one sentence again, then stop.

4:25

— Buffer 35 s

Empty on purpose. Finishing early reads as control; overrunning reads as the opposite.

THE SCRIPT, WORD FOR WORD

Everything you say, in order

Memorise only the first twenty seconds. That is where nerves land, and once the opening is automatic the rest follows. A fully memorised script sounds dead and collapses the moment you lose your place — everything after beat 1 should be yours in your own words.

[CUT IF BEHIND] marks sentences you can drop mid-flight without breaking the logic. Losing them costs detail, not argument.

1 • 0:00 • THE OPENING – KNOW THIS COLD 42 words

“You describe what you want made. We tell you if it’s possible, how to make it, and who can make it.”

Pause. Two full counts. Say nothing. You will want to shorten this – don’t.

“Today that takes a week of emails. We do it in thirty seconds.”

2 • 0:20 • THE BOUNDARY 48 words

“Here’s the line we draw. Five hundred hoodies with your logo? Google solves that, and always will — that is not our market. But a hundred yoga mats that you already own, printed in gold? Nobody can tell you if that is even possible.”

3 • 0:40 • FOUR UNKNOWNNS – FAST, AS A LIST 45 words

“Four things decide it. Can it physically be made. Who accepts goods you already own. Does the minimum order fit. Is the deadline real. Every one of them is knowable — you just find them out one at a time, by email, over a week.”

4 • 0:55 • THE QUOTE, WHICH IS ALSO YOUR WAY INTO THE DEMO 40 words

“We interviewed a Berlin print shop and asked what would actually make this worth using. They said: *ChatGPT macht keine Bewertungen* — it cannot evaluate suppliers. So let me show you what we built instead.”

Never say “so now let me show you my demo”. The quote opens the door for you.

5 • 1:05 • DEMO – FOUR BEATS, 75 SECONDS 95 words

The input text is already in your clipboard. Paste, submit.

“A hundred black yoga mats, PVC, I own them, gold logo, Berlin.”

Point at “Not specified”. Point first, speak half a second later.

“First thing — it tells you what it doesn’t know instead of guessing. ‘Not specified’ is a design decision: unknown is not the same as no.”

Method and citation on screen.

“It picks heat transfer. And it refuses laser on PVC, because that releases hydrogen chloride — and it cites the document it got that from. It doesn’t remember. It retrieves.”

Open one supplier’s score breakdown.

“Three of seven suppliers are eligible. Six factors, each with a reason. This is the screen ChatGPT cannot produce.”

6 • 2:20 • THE ARCHITECTURE – SLIDE 07, 45 SECONDS 115 words

Say the first line before anything else, or the room reads a swimlane as a flowchart. Then walk the ROWS, not the boxes.

“This is how it works. Columns are the four stages. Rows are the layers.”

“Top row is the LangGraph state graph — those are the real node names, fourteen of them, and the blue ones are interrupt points: five places the graph stops and waits for a person.”

“Second row is where a model is allowed to speak. Stage one is structured output into a closed schema, so it cannot invent a field. Stage two runs two model tiers — a small one routes, a large one recommends.”

Point at the wide blue box.

“And from stage three onward there is no model call at all.”

“Third row is retrieval, and it belongs to stage two only. A three-layer ladder decides whether to retrieve, and only the last layer is a model. On any error it retrieves anyway — the model never gets to skip the knowledge base by accident. [CUT IF BEHIND] Underneath it, a FAISS index: thirteen curated documents, fifty-one chunks.”

“Bottom row is code only. Six weighted factors — and that scorer imports nothing from the AI layer. [CUT IF BEHIND] There is a build check that fails if anyone ever adds such an import.”

7 • 3:05 • THE LINE TO LAND, THEN THE TEAM 75 words

“Notice which row has no AI in it. That is the row that decides who gets your money. A supplier will only pay for leads from a system that cannot misrepresent what they can do.”

Team slide. Name them — a named split reads as a team that has already planned the weekend.

“We are three: I’m an AI engineer, Stefan is an AI engineer, Sebastian is a data scientist. Between us: the model layer, the data layer, and the web layer that everything you just saw runs on.”

8 • 3:35 • WHY US FOR AN UNSEEN BRIEF 90 words

Do not promise a build. The brief is released at 10:00 on day one and the judges know it — claiming to know what you will make would say you had not read the format.

“The brief drops at ten on the first morning, and nobody sees it before that. So I am not going to tell you what we will build. I will tell you what we do with a brief

we have never seen.”

“This was a messy real-world domain with no clean dataset anywhere. We shipped it — deployed, three hundred and nine tests, and a customer interview that made us throw away our first positioning and rebuild.”

“An AI build on real Berlin data in forty-eight hours is the shape of problem we have already finished once. [CUT IF BEHIND] Two AI engineers and a data scientist maps onto the data, engineering and web mix the challenge asks for — and we are three, ready to take two more from any school.”

9 • 4:10 • THE CLOSE 38 words

Beat. Then slower than everything before it.

“You describe what you want made. We tell you if it’s possible, how to make it, and who can make it. Send us to Berlin and we’ll make it a transaction.”

Then stop. Add nothing. The last sentence should be the last sentence.

~580 words of speech across 4:25 — about 130 words a minute, which is a presenting pace, not a reading pace.

HOW TO REHEARSE

Three passes, not ten

1. **Sitting, script in hand.** Check the meaning holds and the words sound like you. Change any phrase you would not say naturally — a borrowed phrase is the one you will stumble on.
2. **Standing, out loud, with a timer.** Reading in your head runs about a third faster than speaking, so a script only timed silently will overrun. Note where you actually are at 2:20 and at 3:35.
3. **Standing, no script, deck only.** This proves you remember the structure rather than the phrasing — which is what you actually need on stage.

Rehearse the demo clicks in silence first

Five times, no talking, until your hands know the sequence. **Only then add words.** Motor memory and verbal memory interfere with each other — learning them together is why people fumble a demo they have done a hundred times.

The readiness test for the opening

Say the first sentence while walking, or while somebody is talking to you. **If it survives interference, it will survive the room.**

Two things to practise saying without flinching

- “**We have no paying customers yet.**” Followed immediately by the 30-day plan. Volunteering it is what makes the rest credible.
- “**The suppliers in this demo are sample data**, labelled as such in the app.” Say it during the demo, not when someone catches it.

QUESTIONS YOU WILL GET

Five answers to have ready

Q Isn't this just ChatGPT with extra steps?

“Ask ChatGPT which Berlin shop accepts customer-owned goods at a 100-unit minimum and it will invent a plausible answer that changes when you rephrase the question. **Ours is arithmetic** — six factors, same input, same answer, every factor auditable. And the sharpest version of that line is not ours: it is the print shop we interviewed saying *ChatGPT macht keine Bewertungen.*”

Q Is it multi-agent? Where are the sub-agents?

“**No, and deliberately not.** It is one state graph with fourteen nodes and five human interrupts. What is agentic is the retrieval decision — the system decides whether it needs the knowledge base, and a separate small model does that routing. We didn't add agents talking to agents because every extra degree of freedom is another place a number could be invented, and the whole product rests on the numbers being trustworthy.” **Never claim sub-agents in this room** — somebody will ask where they are.

Q Isn't print sourcing a small market?

“We start with print and merchandise because that is where our knowledge base is real. **The layer underneath generalises to anything custom-made** — ‘can this material take this process’ is the same question for textiles, packaging or furniture. We are deliberately not claiming breadth we have not built yet.”

Q Do you have customers or revenue?

“**No, and I will be precise about it.** The product is deployed, but distribution has not started, and the suppliers in the demo are sample data — labelled as such in the app, because the code refuses to let a demo record claim to be verified. What we do have is one real supplier interview that changed the product.”

Q You are three, and teams are five.

“Correct, and the format allows teams to combine across schools. **We would take two more — ideally a web developer and a second data person** — and we are happy for them to come from another school. We would rather say that now than discover it on day one.” Saying this before anyone asks shows you read the rules, which is itself a signal about how you would run the weekend.

Q You presented alone — what did the others actually do?

Have one concrete sentence each, and do not diminish anyone’s part. Agree the wording with them beforehand so you are not improvising an answer about somebody else’s work.

BEFORE THURSDAY

Six things, and the first two are non-negotiable

- ☐ **Rehearse the demo clicks in silence, five times.**

Non-negotiable. Hands first, words second.

- ☐ **Second browser tab with a finished project already open.**

Non-negotiable. If the demo stalls, switch and keep talking — never debug in front of judges.

- ☐ **One timed run-through, standing, out loud.**

Check where you actually are at 2:20 and 3:35. If you are behind, the cut points are marked in the script.

- ☐ **Input text in the clipboard before you walk up.**

“100 black yoga mats, PVC, I own them, gold logo, Berlin” — typing it live costs fifteen seconds you do not have.

- ☐ **Decide what you say about being three, not five.**

Teams are five and may combine across schools. Volunteer it rather than being asked — it reads as having read the rules.

- ☐ **One warm-up run from the venue, 15 minutes before.**

Clears a cold container and confirms the network. The API budget is already verified.

The slides: [Stage Deck](#) — eleven slides, arrow keys to advance, F11 for full screen. Slide 07 is the architecture.

The live product:

produceyourstuff.up.railway.app

Produce Your Brand · Berlin

Katerina — AI engineer · Sebastian — data scientist · Stefan — AI engineer